Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Middle East/Iran

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Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Middle East, Iran

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit
RA	Regulatory Affairs
LO	Local Organization
IQMS	Integrated Quality Management Solution

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Middle East and Iran are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the IQMS on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the IQMS in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique IQMS number and all relevant follow-up information - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in IQMS - Sends out standard response letters in case it is agreed with the CQU - Supports the process for reimbursement management - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Organizes the complaint sample and sends it to the RQU if requested. - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS - Contacts local CMO on request of GBS as RQU to get investigation reports from the respective CMO - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.1 General Information

Bayer Middle East (BME) was established as a wholly owned subsidiary of Bayer AG in Dubai, U.A.E, to represent Bayer in the Middle East.

There are three legal entities with offices on site:

CCode	Company Name	Country	Site/Office
[1707]	Bayer Middle East FZE	Unit. Arab Emirates/ Jordan	Dubai/ Amman
[1920]	Bayer LLC Saudi Arabia	Saudi Arabia	Jeddah
[1921]	Bayer Limited Egypt L.L.C.	Egypt	Cairo

Sub regions and countries:
Egypt+: consists of Egypt, Libya, Sudan and Yemen
Gulf Countries: consists of UAE, Kuwait, Qatar, Bahrain, Oman and Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
Levant: consists of Palestine, Jordan, Lebanon, Iraq and Syria

Bayer Parsian, Iran, Teheran, country code 10100530774 is under the CQH Turkey responsibility. The complaint handling is performed by GBS PTC officers.

Office addresses:

United Arab Emirates
Bayer Middle East FZE
Dubai Science Park Tower (North) – 13th Floor
Dubai, United Arab Emirates

Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
Bayer Saudi Arabia LLC
2304/2305/2306
King Road Tower – 23 Floor
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

Jordan
Bayer Middle East FZE - Subregion Levant
King Hussein Business Park, building 9
Amman, Jordan

Egypt
Bayer Limited Egypt, LLC
Mivida – Business Park 3
B1 Building – 2nd Floor
New Cairo, Egypt

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.2 Contact list

Country Quality Unit generic email address, applicable both for BME cluster and Iran: *bme.quality@bayer.com*

Egypt

CQH: Mayar Wahdan *mayar.wahdan@bayer.com*

CQH Deputy: Hazem Asad *hazem.asad@bayer.com*

Saudi Arabia

CQH: Yasser Al Mubarak *yasser.almubarak@bayer.com*

CQH Deputy: Hazem Asad *hazem.asad@bayer.com*

Bahrain, Iraq, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Libya, Oman, Palestine, Qatar, Sudan, Syria, United Arab Emirates, Yemen

CQH: Hazem Asad *hazem.asad@bayer.com*

CQH Deputy: Yasser Al Mubarak *yasser.almubarak@bayer.com*

For **Iran** CCQH Sabine İlknur Hırçın: *ilknur.gumuseli-hircin@bayer.com*

Remark:
Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint:

https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list

4.1.3 Escalation Rules — GBS

The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification/immediate action in the IQMS about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations:

- Suspected Counterfeit Cases (notification)
- Any cases involving Health Authorities (notification)
- Cases with final risk category high or medium (escalation via immediate action to the CQH)
- Confirmed counterfeit cases (escalation via immediate action to the CQH)

For **Iran** the above notifications must be sent to: *ilknur.gumuseli-hircin@bayer.com; cilem.diri@bayer.com; didem.cebi@bayer.com; ozum.korkmaz@bayer.com.*
Cases with **final risk category high or medium** are escalated to *ozum.korkmaz@bayer.com* via immediate action.

In the case of questions or comments regarding products which are not classified as PTC, this information is forwarded to the CQU for further handling.

Remark:

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department must be informed via the following e-mail address: ME cluster: *pv.me@bayer.com*, Iran: *pv.iran@bayer.com*	GBS
4.1.5 Product Samples The process of obtaining sample from complainant depends on the fact, if there is a Bayer office in place in complainant country (see chapter 4.1.1). *a)* No Bayer office in country Usually, complaints are received from pharmacy through the authorized Bayer distributor. In case there is no office in the country, ask the distributor to get the sample and send it to manufacturing site, providing the IQMS number (ask to add it as reference to the parcel) and the manufacturing site address. If the complaint received from private person or the physician, the GBS checks with the CQU if a distributor can handle sample shipment. b) Bayer office presents in a country. In this case there are two options to get the sample. The complainant is requested to send the sample to Bayer office (addresses available in chapter 4.1.1) or Bayer authorized distributor (the name of the distributor can be checked with the CQU/CQH case by case). The distributor-once sample received- is responsible for sending it to the manufacturing site. In case when sample is received at Bayer office in the country, ask the office administration (contact list provided below) in the country to send it to a manufacturing site, providing the administration with IQMS number and manufacturing site address. Office administration contact list in case of sample shipment: **Egypt:** *sylvia.george@bayer.com*, *mary.azmy@bayer.com* **UAE:** *flourice.villaraiz@bayer.com* **Saudi Arabia:** *naushad.abdulmajeed@bayer.com* **Jordan:** *abdelwanis.hasanein@bayer.com* In Egypt, Betaferon injector samples are picked up from Patient Support Program by office administrator upon PTC officer request. Give PSP (email address from SafeTrack) in the copy of e-mail to office administrator requesting the pick-up and provide the IQMS number in the request (PSP will label the sample).	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Regulatory Affairs must check if the sample needs health authorities' approval before shipment out of Egypt. Add responsible RA in the e-mail copy to be sent to the office administration requesting sample shipment, to ensure the approval is taken care of. Distributor can handle HA approval themself. **RA contact list.** **Pharma:** Eman Abdel Hamid: *eman.abdelhamid@bayer.com* **Consumer Health:** Abdulrahman Mohsen: *abdulrahman.mohsen@bayer.com* For **Iran** sample shipment is not possible due to overcomplex procedure.	
4.1.6 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** After a complaint is handed in, an immediate acknowledgement of receipt is sent out to the complainant. If there is missing data in the initial complaint (for ex. batch number), the acknowledgment letter will be expanded with the request for providing missing data by the complainant. The acknowledgement letter could be adjusted depending on the current complaint description. - Standard templates are available in Annex 2 (Acknowledgment letter). The acknowledgement letter is not required if a colleague from LO has already acknowledged the complaint receipt, and all information is available. **In response to emails received in Arabic acknowledgement letter is sent in English.** **Response Letter after closing:** Standard response letters are sent out without involvement of the CQU Standard templates are available in Annex 3 (Response letter). In some cases when the standard response doesn't cover the reporter's queries, GBS asks the CQU for support. Responses for complaints received in Arabic are sent also in English. **Exception:** In the following cases CQU is responsible for response letter preparation: # Confirmed final risk categories high and medium # In case of PTC + AE: involvement of PV: involvement of PV- share the complaint conclusion with CQU and local PV, along with prepared template response, asking to accept the template response before sending it to complainant.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
# Authority responses **Remark:** For unconfirmed but plausible defects the response for confirmed defects is shared with the reporter.	
4.1.7 RQU Contact list For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products N/A	
4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements EU GDPR applies in all concerned countries within BME country Cluster. Personal data (name, email address, postal address, phone number, etc.) is stored only in Persona section in IQMS, which is available only for PTC Gdansk officers and local quality colleagues.	
4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) In case when the CQU receives a complaint firstly by phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to the GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because timeline starts when phone complaint is received by the CQU. The written complaints will be placed either in English or Arabic language. Arabic is not hosted language, and the complaints must be translated by contacting Bayer Service Translation Office. If a situation occurs, that there is only a phone number given in the complaint, and any information is missing (for ex. batch number), GBS contacts CQU and asks for support in calling the complainant. Social media monitoring In case of a complaint coming from social media, third party vendor is responsible for contacting the complainant to obtain missing information upon request from GBS.	GBS CQU
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Whether a reimbursement or replacement for a product is granted, depends on the complaint assessment outcome and if the complainant asked for reimbursement or replacement. Only if complaint has been assessed as confirmed quality defect and the complainant asked for compensation, the reimbursement or replacement can be granted upon approval by local commercial and quality functions. To start the reimbursement process, contact the CQH to handle the reimbursement.

Remark

For complaints with RQU abbreviated workflow (CH risk-based approach cases and CH/PH minor damage cases) decision about reimbursement (if was requested) is determined case by case by the CQH. The CQH shares the decision wit the reporter, therefor no response from GBS required.

4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations

GBS

For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should by checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider.

The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations.

Acceptance Criteria:

- No Major translation deviations
- Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%.

. Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major.

- Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured.
- Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message.

In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the IQMS and to ensure appropriate CAPAs.

In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.

4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases

N/A

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.14 Others N/A	

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
1	New document	2021-10-25
2	Remark added in point 4.1.1.	2022-01-17
3	# Whole document: updated abbreviation SSC/SSCDN with GBS and "Shared Service Center" with "Global Business Services" # Address added in point 4.1.1 # Remark added in point 4.1.3 # Change in sample handling in point 4.1.5	2023-02-20
4	#4.1.1 Change in responsibility of Iran quality #4.1.2 CCQH (responsible for Iran) added #4.1.3 group email added in remark	2023-06-14
5	# New SOP template used # 4.1.1 Bayer Parsian is out of BME scope. Palestine added. Saudi Arabia office address updated. Egypt office address updated. # 4.1.2 Contact list updated according to changes in cluster responsibilities. # 4.1.5 Office administration emails added. RA contact list updated; wording adjusted. # 4.1.6 Wording adjusted. Information about acknowledgement and response in Arabic language added. # Response letter updated # Acknowledgement letter updated	2024-11-11
6	# Distribution sheet updated # Training role updated # Through the document, "Dev@Com" replaced by "IQMS" Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Section 4.1.2 Reference to QINT SharePoint updated # Section 4.1.3 Escalation rules: escalation on initial risk category removed, escalation regarding final risk categories changed to high and medium according to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0. Reference to QINT SharePoint updated. # Section 4.1.7 Updated references to global lists with RQU names for PH and CH # Chapter 4.1.1 Remark removed # Chapter 4.1.4 Iran PV address added. # Chapter 4.1.5 Statement regarding Iran samples added # Chapter 4.1.6 Responses and letters of acknowledgement rules for Arabic complaints specified. Remark added # Chapter 4.1.9 Updated acc to process change # Chapter 4.1.11 Remark added # Chapter 4.1.13 Remark removed	See cover page

	# Acknowledgement and response letters updated # Document name changed from SSC-PTC-SOP-ME-016 to SSC-PTC-SOP-ME-IR-016 # Document name changed from “Country Specific Requirements Middle East” to “Country Specific Requirements Middle East/Iran”	

7 Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

8 Templates

Annex 2



Acknowedgement letter.docx

Annex 3



Response letter.docx

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